

FIELD REPORT: ON CERY'S SABLEWOOD THE ASHEN

Filed by: an ash-road observer Subject: Cerys Sablewood the Ashen
Condition of testimony: incomplete; certain passages rest upon
overheard speech and may be colored by fear

Cerys Sablewood the Ashen is a major Master of Coin. This much is repeated wherever coin is counted, weighed, hidden, or denied. Whether the title is borne by right, purchase, or necessity, I cannot establish. Cerys was born in 330 AS, though the date is spoken more confidently by ledgers than by living mouths.

The subject presents the controlled, calculating atmosphere expected of a Master of Coin carrying a hidden royal inheritance. I record the wording carefully: Cerys is the unacknowledged heir to the Bleeding Crown. "Unacknowledged" is the hinge upon which all other statements turn. The claim is not openly owned, yet it follows Cerys like smoke beneath a door. Some who speak of it lower their voices. Others smile as though they have discovered a profitable joke. I advise neither practice.

No canonical physical features are established for Cerys Sablewood the Ashen. Reports that offer height, coloring, scars, or other bodily particulars are therefore unverified and should not be entered into a serious account. The epithet "the Ashen" provides Cerys's defining visual identity. It is less an ornament than a shadow placed upon the name. Those who insist they saw some unmistakable sign may be remembering the title rather than the person.

In dealings, Cerys is said to make silence feel like an assessment. A pause becomes a measure. A glance becomes an inventory. Even an empty purse seems, in Cerys's presence, to possess a hidden compartment. I cannot say whether this is craft or merely the effect of expecting craft. The difference matters to scholars and not at all to those awaiting an answer.

No testimony gathered here proves that Cerys openly claims the Bleeding Crown. No testimony proves that the Crown accepts Cerys. The inheritance remains hidden and unacknowledged, which may be the same as powerless, or may be the exact condition required for power to survive.

Final assessment: treat Cerys Sablewood the Ashen as a major Master

of Coin, born in 330 AS, and as the unacknowledged heir to the Bleeding Crown. Treat every further certainty as a coin held up to the light: possibly genuine, possibly shaved, and never offered without purpose.